



THE NATURE OF CONFLICT

COURSE OUTLINE

Time: 8 hours (8:30 a.m. - 5:00 p.m.)

This program is for individuals at all levels within any large organization.

PURPOSE STATEMENT

This program is for individuals to:

1. Learn to be personally responsible for handling tough situations
2. Resolve conflict in themselves and with their team members
3. Understand how to dissipate conflicts from relationships

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of the program, participants will have the knowledge and skill to:

- Understand and address the sources of conflict.
- Demonstrate being personally responsible as the key to resolving personal conflict.
- Understand, demonstrate and apply the Conflict Resolution Model.
- Understand, demonstrate and apply the Team Conflict Resolution Model.
- Utilize team conflict productively to create alignment to produce acceptable outcomes.

PROGRAM OUTLINE

1. Program Opening
 - Program overview – Purpose, Methods, and Outcomes
2. Icebreaker Activity "My Way or the Highway"
 - Enrolls the participants into the program and sets the stage for what will be taught throughout the rest of the day.
3. Potential Outcomes of Constructive Conflict (Discussion)
 - Voice problems, or dissatisfaction for understanding
 - Eliminate sources of dissatisfaction
 - Create solutions
 - Revitalize meaning or need for norms
 - Prevent stagnation
 - Stimulate interest and curiosity
 - Establish new balance of power
 - Establish identities
 - Change attitudes and perceptions of parties in relationship to one another
 - Promote change
 - Generate new, creative ideas
 - Increase depth of relationship
 - Increase team synergies

THE NATURE OF CONFLICT

PROGRAM OUTLINE (CONT.)

4. Sources of Conflict (Discussion)

- Taking things personally
- Territoriality
- Projection
- Misunderstanding
- Diversity of thought or approach
- Lack of empathy or compassion
- Unconsciousness
- Change
- External or internal threat
- Living in the past or in the future

5. Personal Responsibility and Reaction (Teaching and Application)

No matter what the other party is doing or how it looks to us, we decide how to respond. We are not limited to a narrow range of reactions. Discovering how we are the source of the uncomfortable feelings, instead of the other person, brings great personal power and freedom to act in new ways. For example, a need to be right all the time creates little space for the creative exchange of ideas. That need to be right could produce insults and inflexibility that are perceived as coming from the other person when in reality, they stem from one's own insecurities.

6. Slice of Life Activity– Individual Conflict (Demonstration)

Live demonstration from the front of the room with audience participation, of a simulated situation, relevant to the content being taught. "Slices of Life are about creating an internal realization of the conflicts and challenges, creating a very clear path to success." – Judith Orloff, President/CEO, Educational Discoveries

7. Conflict Resolution Model (Teaching and Discussion)

- Recognize and acknowledge the conflict
- Recognize whether you're in reaction and, if so, choose to become neutral. Apply Stop, Look, Listen, and Act Tool.
- Decide whether you will participate in resolving this conflict
- Get agreement to discuss the conflict
- Listen to the other person
- Choose a resolution that is in the best interest of the customer and/or the organization

8. Conflict Resolution Individual Practice – Activity

Participants experience that with the right tools conflict can be quickly mitigated. Method: Individuals practice in groups of three using the conflict model with awareness of creating an environment of alignment.





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PROGRAM OUTLINE (CONT.)

9. Teach Giving and Receiving Feedback

- **GIVING** – Describe the action in a neutral way with nothing added or withheld, including the results of the action. Don't make assumptions about WHY the action happened.
- **RECEIVING** – Listen to what people tell you without arguing with them, even if you don't agree with them. Consider the possibility of truth in what they say.

10. Feedback Exercise

- Take a moment to think about what conflicts arise in an organization when issues go unspoken that need to be said.
- Would you say that this happens at your organization?
- Think about receiving and giving feedback at your organization.
- What do you need to give feedback on?
- Who do you need to give feedback to?
- Is it coming from your ego or from your desire to create alignment?
- Why is it important?
- Now, discuss these issues in your teams.

11. Team Conflict Resolution Model (Teaching and Discussion)

- Assess the situation.
- Outwardly acknowledge the conflict to the team.
- Give feedback to the players.
- Involved to act personally responsible by demonstrating it in your communication.
- Set behavior expectations relative to resolving differences.
- Share the behavior changes you require on the part of the team members so that the conflict does not continue.
- Determine steps for resolving the conflict in the future.

12. Team Conflict Slice of Life (front of the room demonstration)

13. Team Conflict Resolution Activity

- Team practice using the external Team Conflict Resolution Model

14. Personal Commitments – Action Planning

Here, participants will develop plans that will address the skills taught in the course. Participants will address what they can do to better:

- Resolve conflict in themselves
- Resolve conflict in their teams
- Creatively utilize conflict to achieve forward thinking solutions

15. Program Close and Celebration

Conflict Resolution



Participant Workbook

EDUCATIONAL DISCOVERIES

The Nature of Conflict

Conflict is natural, neither positive or negative, it just is.

Conflict is just an interference pattern of energies.

Nature uses conflict as its primary motivator for change, creating beautiful beaches, canyons, mountains, and pearls.

It's not *whether* you have conflict in your life.
It's what you *do* with that conflict that makes a difference.

Conflict is not a Contest.

Winning and losing are goals for games, not for conflicts.

Learning, growing, and cooperating are goals for resolving conflicts.

Conflict can be seen as a gift of energy, in which neither side loses
and a new dance is created.

Resolving conflict is rarely about who is right.
It is about acknowledgment and appreciation of differences.

Conflict begins within. As we unhitch the burden of belief systems
and heighten our perceptions, we love more fully and freely.

Tom Crum, *Magic of Conflict*

Operating Definitions

Conflict: *Two opposing forces meeting;
if resolved, it creates a new order.*

**WE
DID
IT!**



Fight: *A battle to survive
where somebody wins and somebody loses;
it preserves the old order.*



Step 1 for Resolving Conflict:

**Recognize and acknowledge
that there *is* a fight.**

When you are agitated around another person—
when you feel hurt, nasty, righteous, inferior, superior,
or have any judgements— you are in a fight.



What fights are going on in your life right now?

Who are you fighting with?	Describe the fight	How will it end?

Do I *want* to end the fight?

Why Yes:

Why No:

Step 2 for Resolving Conflict:

Decide whether you will end the fight.

The willingness to be open to all possible solutions to a conflict creates:

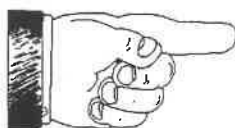
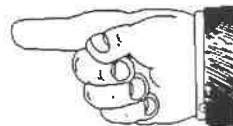
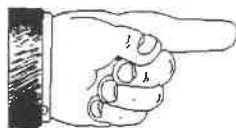
- Responsible behavior
- Personal freedom from past patterns
- The foundation for compassion, empathy and forgiveness



Step 3 for Resolving Conflict:

Give up blame.

It keeps you small,
expecting someone else to do something
so you will feel and be okay.



What I learned about myself in the exercise:

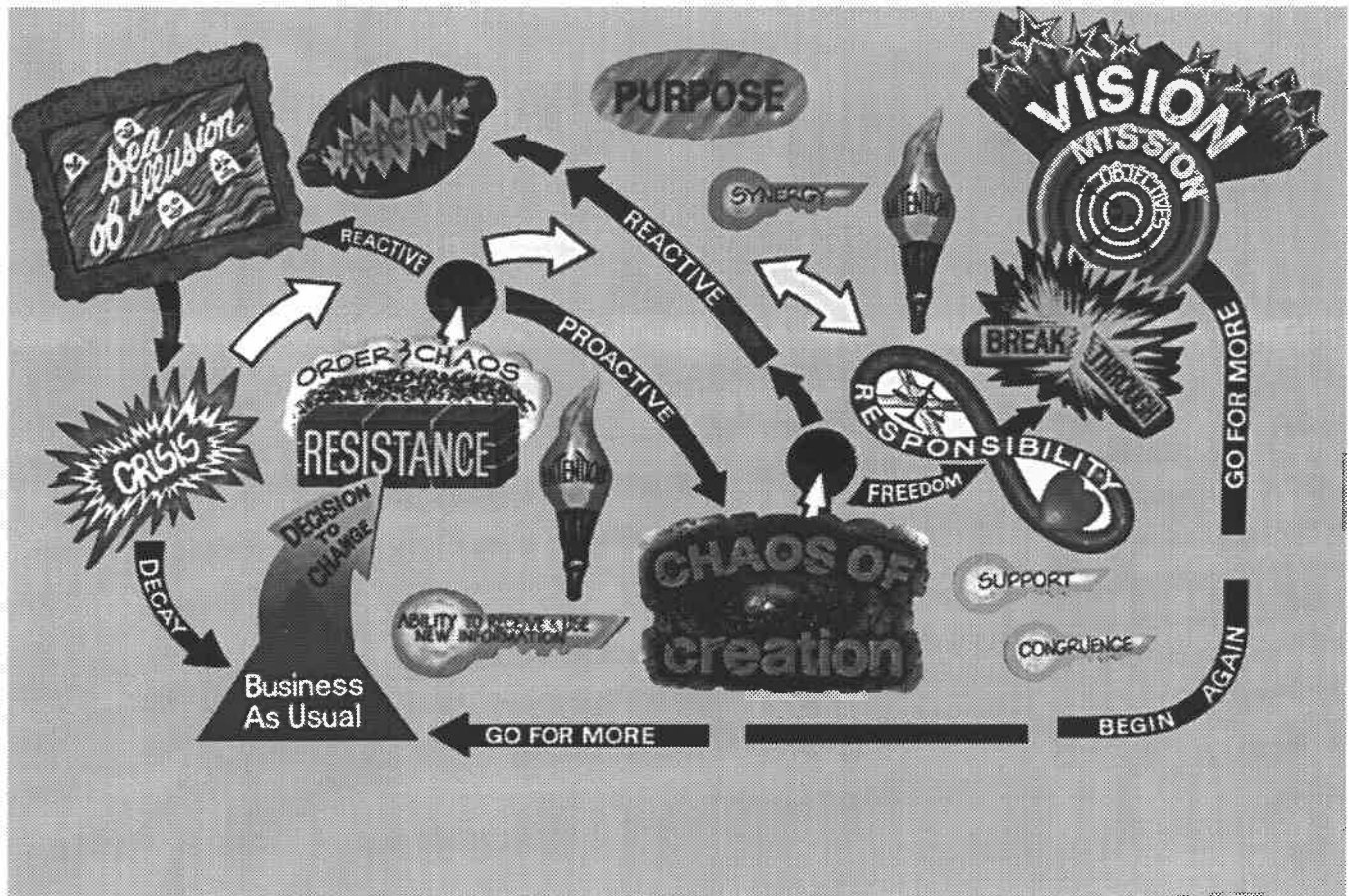
What I learned about the person I'm in a fight with:

When I go deep inside, what I discover about the fight:

The Model For a Paradigm Shift

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10 Keys to Navigating Through Change

Step 1 - Decision to Change

The *Decision to Change* can come from a voluntary internal decision, but is often forced from external sources. Either way, this is the point at which you recognize the need to change and leave the status quo. It is not necessary to like it, however, the decision will be easier if there is a clear *Vision*, strong *Intention*, and *Support* to carry it through. If the decision has been thrust upon you, it will help to spend the time necessary to accept and align internally with the *Decision to Change*.

Step 2 - Resistance—Order & Chaos

Resistance is the natural response to any *Decision to Change*. It contains the balance of *Order*—the desire to stay with what you know, and *Chaos*—the need and desire to move forward to the unknown.

The interaction of *Order* and *Chaos* creates agitation and often is uncomfortable. The temptation is strong here to deny or try to overcome one or the other. Neither should be viewed as “good” or “bad.” Embracing the initial paradox of *Resistance* gives the necessary strength and clarity to accomplish the change.

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Step 3 - Choice Point

After staying in the discomfort of *Order* and *Chaos*, eventually something has to give—you move to a *Choice Point*. This is your first critical moment of choice since your *Decision to Change*. How you have dealt with *Resistance* has a great influence on the choice here. You will either proactively move forward on your intended path of change or reactively move toward illusion. The illusory path is both tricky and compelling. Usually on the reactive path you will claim that you are moving toward change, while upholding an internal commitment to the past.

Step 4 - Reactive Change—Sea of Illusion

Illusion is both powerful and tricky—you think and act as if you are on the right path to change, but it's deceptive—you are really stuck in the past. You know the past does not work. If the past was workable, there would be no need to change in the first place. Supporting someone else in this place is always very difficult, because they are telling themselves either that the change wasn't necessary or that they have already achieved it. Living in self-deception eventually erodes your self-esteem and ultimately leads to a *Crisis*.

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... Step 5 - Crisis

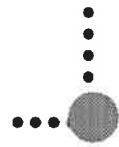
Crisis is the inevitable result of consistently choosing *Illusion*, because you cannot see what you are doing. *Crisis* can be viewed as nature's wake-up call to get back on track. It is a great opportunity to jump immediately to the path of proactive change—to recommit to the change and mean it this time. *Crisis* also represents danger, for to continue in denial and *Illusion* will cause further escalated levels of decay.

Step 6 - Proactive Change—Chaos of Creation

This is the decision to risk the unknown and do something new—to stay with your intention to change. The *Chaos of Creation* is usually intense and emotional because although you've decided what you are going to do, you still do not know how you will do it. *Chaos* happens because you get pulled in many directions while looking for new success patterns. *Creation* happens when you are committed to making new decisions and choosing new behaviors.

The major distinction between *Chaos of Creation* and *Illusion* is that in *Chaos*, people seek true *Support*, they take *Support* when given, and they are always seeking new information. In *Illusion*, people will be defensive and feel threatened. All change involves willingness to risk, however, *Chaos of Creation* is not to be viewed as “risky.” Even though lots of people are risking here, they are self-aware, have a clear objective, and lots of *Support*, so that mistakes and corrections can happen quickly.

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Step 7 - Choice Point Two—Intention and Support

Chaos of Creation is extremely uncomfortable. To stay in the discomfort requires a very clear *Vision*, strong *Intention*, and *Support*. While in *Chaos*, it is very easy to lose sight of your *Vision*. Having people who know your *Intention* and *Vision* will help you stay on track through difficult times. Inevitably, this discomfort creates a temptation to return to the tried and true—the past—the *Sea of Illusion*. After living in the *Chaos of Creation* for what usually seems like a long time, another *Choice Point* emerges. This is the point at which you choose either to return to the past (*Illusion*) or to move closer to your *Vision* by choosing *Freedom*.

Step 8 - Freedom and Personal Responsibility

Seeing yourself as the source of your experience is the most powerful position available to you, because you give up excuses and blame for why things worked out or didn't work out. This represents a new paradigm for most people, because you literally change the way you see things. The same situation or data means something different to you than it did before. You see the past differently—you see it more as the result of your knowledge and choices then. You don't judge yourself for how you were, or are, nor do you throw up your arms or shrug your shoulders as if the mistakes didn't matter. You are more committed to correcting mistakes than judging yourself or others for them. Compassion for yourself and others is essential here. Without it, there is no safety to be vulnerable and to talk honestly. Now, new solutions to old problems can happen easily.

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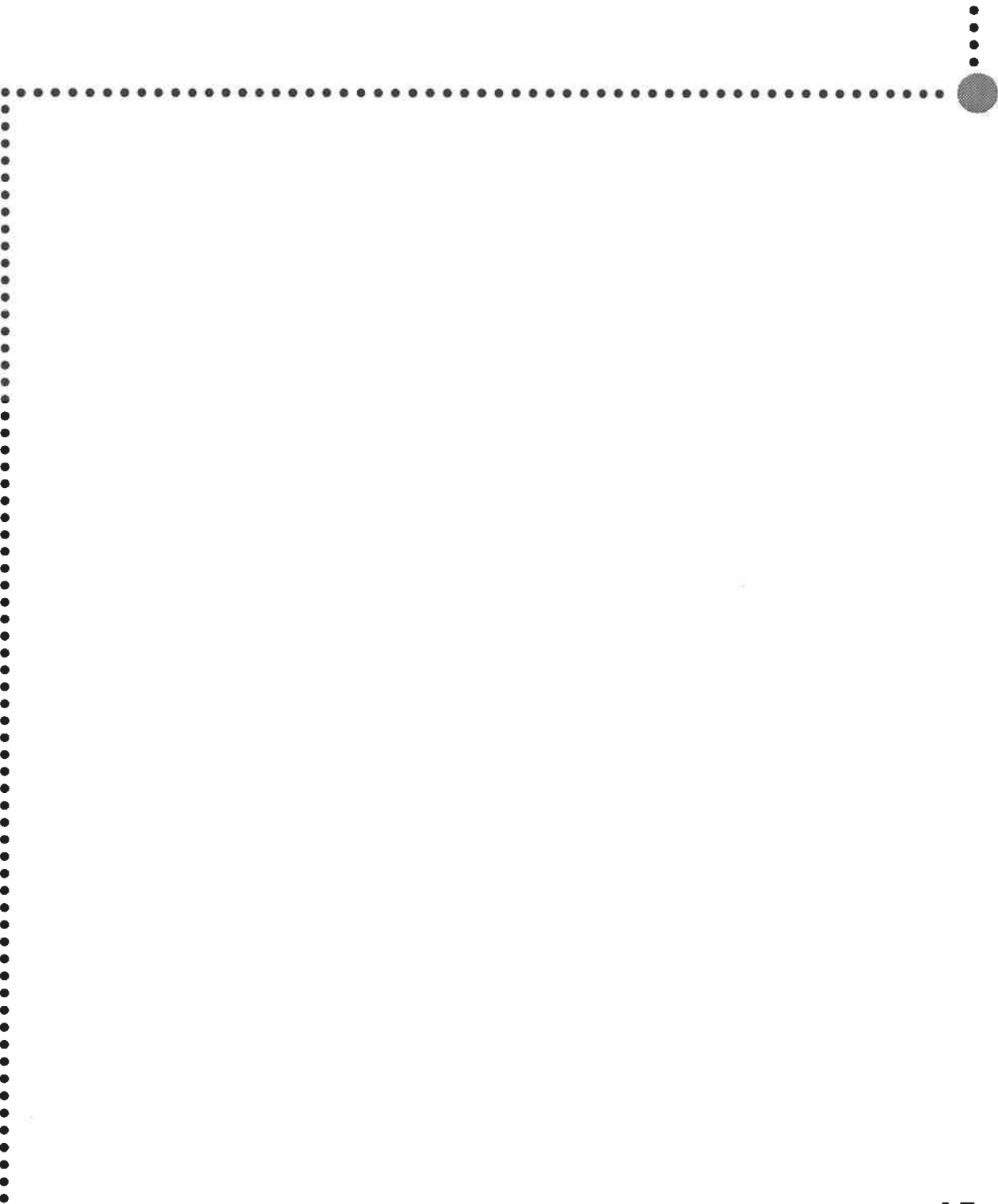
... Step 9 - Breakthrough

This is the last critical point before achieving your *Vision*. You are ninety-eight per cent of the way to your dream, and all of a sudden, you realize that it doesn't feel, look, or seem like what you thought it would. In other words, it doesn't fit your pictures of what you thought it would be like. You may want to give up or abandon the entire effort. There is usually some final *Illusion* you are holding onto about yourself or your *Vision*. What is critical here is to remember your decision and *Intention* and stay *Congruent* using everything you have learned so far. It is inevitable and okay that things don't look and feel as expected. If you continue to risk the unknown, you will have continued *Breakthroughs* and will get closer and more connected to your *Vision*.

Step 10 - Purpose, Vision, Mission, and Objectives

As you grow in this process, often the *Vision* you began the process with will evolve and become clearer. You may even realize that what had been your *Vision* might be your *Mission*, or even one of your *Objectives* along the path to your *Vision*. Also, the closer you live to your *Vision*, you will experience inevitably your *Purpose*. As you follow your proactive path to change, you will sense your *Purpose* permeating everything you do. You will experience that your *Vision* is the picture of your *Purpose* brought to life.

Notes



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The Players*

GO-GETTER

Your job is to experience the paradox of a paradigm shift while navigating through *The Model for Change*. You can do this by experiencing how change happens and how it doesn't happen. You don't just bull through; you feel the different phases.

VISION

You are a guiding light. You are the picture of the Go-Getter's purpose brought to life. Wherever the Go-Getter goes, you continuously inspire her to realize her highest purpose.

MISSION

You are the action plan of the big picture. You are how the organization will accomplish its vision. You are big enough to hold all the targets of the organization. You are smart enough not to be bothered by mistakes and corrections.

OBJECTIVES

You are specific, measurable targets the Go-Getter aims for. You measure whether she is on track toward her vision.

INTENTION

Your power focuses the will of the Go-Getter. You belong to the world of action. Where goeth the will of the Go-Getter, so you goeth too.

* Because our language has not evolved to accommodate a non-sexist term for he/she, we are using the pronoun she in this section.

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SUPPORT

You assist the Go-Getter through *The Model for Change*. You remind the Go-Getter of her purpose, to help her stay through the chaos and keep the Go-Getter connected to her Vision. You tell the truth.

BUSINESS AS USUAL

You are the status quo. You are established and conservative. You know what has always worked in the past. You have no interest in change or in the Go-Getter.

DECISION TO CHANGE

You are brave, courageous and bold. You understand the necessity for change. You propel the Go-Getter in the direction of her vision.

RESISTANCE

You are a result of a decision to change. You represent fear and appear rigid and immovable. You are surrounded by a balance of Order and Chaos.

ORDER

You are the voice of reason. You see the risks inherent in change and are distrustful of it. You push the Go-Getter back toward Business As Usual. You want everything to stay the same. You like the familiar. Your power is equal to Chaos, and together you pull the Go-Getter back and forth.

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CHAOS

You are stormy, wild, scary and joyful. You are the essential ingredient for change. You pull the Go-Getter forward on her chosen path. Your power is equal to Order, and together you pull the Go-Getter back and forth.

CHOICE POINT ONE

The Go-Getter does not reach you until there is enough agitation from Order and Chaos. You don't care which direction the Go-Getter takes and are impartial whether she is reactive or proactive. In science, you are known as bifurcation.

ILLUSION

You represent the past and what is most comfortable. You are familiar, vague and confused. You try to make the Go-Getter comfortable and reassure her that everything is as it should be. You tell the Go-Getter that you are the tried and true choice and try to persuade her to stay with you.

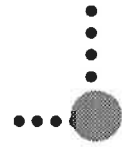
REACTION

You are the invisible component of Illusion. You are the trap that Illusion covers. Your energy is a powerful force because you don't tell the truth about anything. You are adamantly right or wrong about everything. Eventually you explode.

CRISIS

You are the moment of truth. You are paradoxical. Your purpose is to re-awaken the Go-Getter to her Decision to Change. As danger, you threaten the existence of the Go-Getter. As opportunity, you are a turning point—a chance to get back on Purpose.

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CHAOS OF CREATION

You are an open system. You are a storm full of upheaval, excitement, upset, fear, peace, and possibility all at once. You are like the raw force of nature that precedes creation. You contain the elements of:

Fear	You tell the Go-Getter what she could lose.
The Unknown	You are silent, hidden, mysterious.
Paradox	You are full of contradiction: you tell the Go-Getter about the old and the new at the same time.
Excitement	You are all the possibilities of success. You strengthen the Go-Getter's Intention to achieve her Mission and Vision.
Risk	You remind the Go-Getter of the dangers and the possibilities.
Naked Truth	You are the peaceful center of creation.
Joy	You are aware of the opportunity in every moment and feel wonderful.

Together, you spin the Go-Getter around in the dizzying spiral of the Chaos of Creation.

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... CHOICE POINT TWO

The Go-Getter does not reach you until there is enough agitation from the Chaos of Creation. You are impartial whether the Go-Getter is reactive or proactive. To take either path, the Go-Getter must be accompanied by Intention. To take the proactive path, the Go-Getter must be accompanied by Intention and Support.

RESPONSIBILITY

You are the essence of choice, change, and power. You are the most powerful way of being the Go-Getter has. You are able to respond to a situation in the moment because you see yourself as the source of what happens. You do not judge. You welcome the Go-Getter, Intention, and Support with open arms and propel them through Breakthrough.

BREAKTHROUGH

Experiencing you is the final step to change. You represent the final commitment. You welcome the Go-Getter through if she is accompanied by Responsibility, Support, and strong Intention.